[METRIC]
A-A-2908
April 24, 1995

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION
PENCIL, MECHANICAL FOR 1.1MM SIZE LEAD /COLORED
(Push / Twist Action)

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this Commercial Item Description by all federal agencies in lieu of Federal Specification SS-P-186E Type I (a) and replaces CID A-A-2783 and CID A-A-2765 which is canceled.

1. Scope: This commercial item description covers mechanical pencils which accommodate graphite and clay leads.

2. Classification:

Types: 1 - Type I - Push Action
2 - Type II- Twist Action

3. Salient Characteristics:

3.1 Mechanical pencils shall consist of a barrel which contains a lead holding mechanism suitable to propel, repel, and or expel leads (as applicable), a metal point, a metal pocket clip, and a replaceable eraser.

3.2 Mechanical pencils shall operate by a lead holding device which shall operate as indicated in paragraph 3.2 1 and 3.2.2 to propel / expel the lead in short, uniform increments to a usable length from the sleeve end, and shall operate smoothly and easily, without binding, bending, breaking or malfunctioning.

3.2.1 Type I mechanical pencils shall have the clutch mechanism activated by pressing the push button located at the top (eraser end) of the pencil to propel and expel lead from the point.

3.2.2 Type II mechanical pencil shall have operate by twist action which is activated by turning the top portion of the pencil (eraser end) to propel, repel, and expel lead from the point.

3.3 The pencils shall be of the following colors: Black (graphite HB hardness), Blue (clay), Red (clay), and as specified in section 7.2.

DISTRIBUTION STATEMENT A. Approved for public release;
Distribution is unlimited.

FSC 7520

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3.4 The barrel shall be formed in accordance with commercial practice.

3.5 The mechanism and point shall hold the lead firmly, without breaking, so that the lead does not turn or slip into or out of the pencil. The pencil shall be capable of dispensing the specified lead size.

3.6 Lead shall not fall free from the pencil such that the lead when reduced to a length of 7mm shall continue to be retained in the pencil.

3.7 Manufacturer's name / Trademark, and point size shall be exhibited on the pencil. Placement of these markings shall be at the option of the manufacturer, provided that they are prominently legible.

3.8 Type I pencils shall contain three leads and type II pencils shall contain one lead. The lead shall be 100mm ± 2mm in length.

3.9 Erasers shall be made in accordance with Commercial Item Description A-A-132 item number 5 and shall be a pencil type suitable for cleanly erasing lead markings without crumbling or breaking. Due to the wax in the colored leads, erasability of colored leads does not apply.

3.10 Workmanship: Mechanical pencils shall be securely assembled so that parts do not become loose or displaced and shall be free from defects or imperfections which may adversely affect appearance or serviceability.

4. Regulatory Requirements

"The offerer/contractor is encouraged to use recovered materials in accordance with paragraph 23.403 of the Federal Acquisition Regulation (FAR)."

4.1 Toxicity. Use of any toxic substance must be in accordance with all applicable federal statutes. The use of any known carcinogens as ingredients is prohibited. The harmful substances shall be defined as the poison and injurious substances as designated in Fed.Std. 313. The vendor shall prepare a certification that the pencil conforms to the above requirements.

4.2 Material Safety Data Sheets. Safety data sheets shall be furnished in accordance with Fed. Std. 313. The pertinent government mailing addresses for submission of data are listed in appendix B of Fed. Std. 313.

4.3 Labeling. Containers shall be labeled to comply with the "Federal Hazardous Substances Act Regulations", 16 Code of Federal Regulations, Part 1500.

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as directed by ... specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or

5. **Quality Assurance Requirements:**

5.1 Contractor Certification. The contractor shall certify and maintain substantiating evidence that the product offered meets the salient characteristics of this Commercial Item Description, and that the product conforms to the producer's own drawings, specifications, standards, and quality assurance practices. The government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance prior to first delivery and therefore as may be otherwise provided for under the provisions of the contract.

5.2 Responsibility For Inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, The supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified, the supplier shall utilize his own facilities or any commercial laboratory acceptable to the government. The government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure that supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

5.3 Examination and Testing:

5.3.1 Suppliers are encouraged to use quality control (QC) techniques that exhibit control over their processes (e.g. (Statistical Process Control) SPC Techniques) as defined in American National Standards Institute (ANSI) Z1.1, Z1.2 and Z1.3 / American Society for Quality Control (ASQC) B.1, B.2 and B.3 that systematically reduce excess variations. Objective evidence shall be available that demonstrates overall measurement adequacy techniques and controls. These techniques shall ensure quality levels equal to, or greater than, those cited in applicable technical document or, herein.

5.3.2 End item inspection/testing may be used by the offeror or the Government representative, as a means to determine the effectiveness of the in process quality controls. In process controls shall not be substituted for end item performance testing.

5.3.3 For those characteristics for which there are no such controls, or for end item performance test, lot by lot sampling for inspection/test shall be required. Sampling shall be in accordance with the American National Standards Institute (ANSI) / American Society for Quality Control (ASQC) Z1.4, Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.

5.3.4 An inspection lot shall consist of all like items submitted for inspection at one time. The inspection level shall be S-2 with an AQL of 4.0 Per Hundred Units (DHU) for A-A-2908. The supplier must provide objective evidence (tests and inspection records) that the presented material meets the requirements of the sampling plan as indicated above.

6. **Packaging:** Preservation, packing and marking shall be as specified in the contract or order.

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6. **Packaging:** Preservation, packing and marking shall be as specified in the contract or order.

7. **Notes:**

7.1 Applicable Documents. Issues of the following documents, in effect on the date of invitation for bids or request for proposal form a part of this document to the extent specified herein.

7.1.1 Federal Acquisition Regulation (FAR) may be obtained from the Superintendent of Documents, Government Printing Office, Washington. DC 20402

7.1.2 ANSI / ASQC Z1.4 may be obtained from the American Society for Quality Control, PO Box 3005, 611 E. Wisconsin Avenue, Milwaukee, Wisconsin 53201-4606.

7.2. Ordering Information: Purchasers shall select the required options permitted herein, and include the following information in procurement documents:

A. Title, number, and date of this commercial item description.
B. Purchasers shall specify the lead color. If color **(other)** is required, the specified color shall be specified.
C. Purchasers shall specify arrangement for inspection and facilities if other than specified.
D. Purchasers shall specify packaging, packing, and any special marking for shipment.
E. Purchasers shall specify if Identification marking, if other than required.
F. Purchasers shall specify if bar coding is not required.
G. Purchasers shall specify palletization, if required.

7.3 National Stock Number Listing:

Push Action

7520-01-347-9581
7520-01-354-2304
7520-01-354-2305

Twist Action

7520-00-164-8950
7520-00-268-9915
7520-00-268-9916

MILITARY INTERESTS:
NONE: DoD has no registered interest in revisions and amendments to this Commercial Item Description until further Notice.

PREPARING ACTIVITY
GSA-FSS

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